

*Lagothrix cana*

Gray woolly monkey



Location C. South America

Length 18–26 in (45–65 cm)

Tail 21–32 in (53–80 cm)

Weight 11–22 lb (5–10 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Endangered



Woolly monkeys have thick, soft, close-curved fur, which in this species is gray with black flecks, darker gray on the head, hands, feet, and tail tip. In some individuals, there is a reddish tinge on the underparts. It lives in a mixed troop, which breaks into subgroups to forage primarily for

fruit but also for leaves, flowers, sap, seeds, and small creatures. This peaceful, gentle monkey often allows members of another troop into its own troop's territory. After a gestation period of 223–225 days, the single offspring is born and clings to its mother's underside, moving on to her back at 7 days. It is weaned after 6 months. Males grow larger than females when mature.

MUSCULAR MOVER

Woolly monkeys are stout-bodied and almost pot-bellied, with powerful shoulders, hips, and tail, for hanging from and swinging through trees.



CONSERVATION

As well as being threatened by deforestation, adult grey woolly monkeys are frequently hunted, and their young are kept as pets. Conservation depends mainly on hunting restrictions, which in remote parts of the Amazon basin can be difficult to enforce.



*Ateles hybridus*

Variegated spider monkey



Location N.W. South America

Length 18–20 in (45–50 cm)

Tail 29–32 in (74–81 cm)

Weight 17–23 lb (7.5–10.5 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Critically endangered



The variegated spider monkey has a conspicuous triangular white patch on the forehead. It is brown above with pale underparts—giving rise to its other common name of white-bellied spider monkey. Mixed troops of about 20 split into single-sex subgroups of 3–4 to feed on fruit, juicy leaves, and, oddly,

soft, decaying wood. They whoop and whinny as they meet up again. Like all spider monkeys, it has long limbs, a slim body, thumbless hands, and a prehensile tail.



*Brachyteles arachnoides*

Southern muriqui



Location C. South America (S.E. Brazil)

Length 18¼–25 in (47.5–63 cm)

Tail 26–30 in (65–76 cm)

Weight 19–22½ lb (8.5–10.2 kg)

Social unit Variable

Status Endangered



Also known as the woolly spider monkey, the southern muriqui has a heavy body, long limbs, and thumbless hands with hooklike fingers. It is the largest New World monkey, and, being a leaf-eater, is endangered due to destruction of Atlantic coastal forests. There are fewer than 1,500 individuals left in the wild, most of which are found in the Carlos Botelho State Park.

*Ateles geoffroyi*

Geoffroy's spider monkey



Location S. Mexico, Central America

Length 12–25 in (31–63 cm)

Tail 25–34 in (64–86 cm)

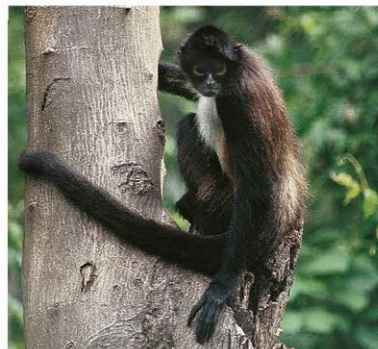
Weight 13–21 lb (6–9.5 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Endangered



Also known as the black-handed spider monkey, this species has black hands, head, and feet, and a cowl-like face surround. Like other spider monkeys, the thumbless hand acts as a simple hook, to swing agilely through trees or to pull fruit-laden branches to the mouth.



*Ateles chamek*

Black spider monkey



Location W. South America

Length 16–23½ in (40–60 cm)

Tail 28–35 in (70–88 cm)

Weight 11–15 lb (5–7 kg)

Social unit Group

Status Endangered



Long, black fur and black facial skin identify this otherwise typical spider monkey, which feeds mainly on fruit, berries, flowers, soft leaves, grubs, termites, and honey. They live in large territorial troops, each occupying 370–570 acres (150–230 hectares). The troop splits into variable subgroups to feed, and meets in the evening with greeting calls.

